TOURISM

Tourism is travelling for recreation. Tourists originated when large numbers of middle class people began to join the more wealthy aristocratic travellers. As societies became wealthier, and people lived longer, it became more and more likely that lower-middle class and middle class people steadily employed would retire in good health and with significant savings.

A tourist can usually be seen as clearly "out of place" in his current surroundings, so he is not confused with other travellers. The term "tourist" is tied to the activity of taking a tour or sightseeing. It is not limited to travelling, but used as a description of a person who enters a situation or culture, for a brief time, requiring knowledge that he does not have.

The tourist can be interested - among other things - in the new place's culture or its nature. Wealthy people have always travelled to distant parts of the world, not, for any special purpose, but simply for travelling as an end in itself: to see great buildings or other works of art; to learn new languages; and to taste new cuisines.

Organized tourism is now a major industry around the world and many national economies are now heavily reliant on tourism.

The term tourism is sometimes used in an uncomplimentary manner, implying a shallow interest by tourists in general in the societies and natural wonders they visit.

EXERCISE 1: Find words or phrases in the passage which mean the same as:

COLUMN A **COLUMN B**

a) refreshment of one's mind or body after work through activity that amuses or stimulates .....

b) not subject to change or variation; regularly .....

c) large or important .....

d) not fitting in with one's surroundings *(phrase)* .....

e) occurring at or belonging to the present time .....

f) get two things mixed up; be mistaken for *(phrase)* .....

g) lasting fora short time .....

h) faraway .....

i) desirable, even though you may achieve nothing by it *(phrase)* .....

j) (of a region, country, or culture) characteristic style of cooking .....

k) dependent on something for support .....

i) expressing disapproval .....

m) suggest something without actually saying it .....

n) not involving serious or careful thought .....

EXERCISE 2: Choose the correct answer according to the passage.

1. According to the passage, a tourist . . . . . .

A) has to be rich in order to relax during the holiday
B) usually carries out business abroad
C) is usually studying the local language
D) isn't normally obvious among natives
E) visits places with the aim of enjoying them

2. It is clear from the passage that tourism . . . . . .

A) is not favoured by the rich people of the place being visited
B) includes business travel and foreign studies as well
C) makes up a significant percentage of the economies of some countries
D) encourages other types of trade between nations
E) helps to eliminate cultural differences between nations

3. It is mentioned in the passage that . . . . . .

A) only those who have just retired with a lot of money make good tourists
B) tourists normally prepare in advance to feel at ease within the foreign countries they visit
C) tourists are not welcome in most countries
D) tourism costs some countries a lot of money
E) most tourists are not interested in communicating with natives other than on a superficial level

EXERCISE 3: Complete the sentences by selecting words from Column B in EXERCISE 1.

1. I felt a bit ..... in the restaurant in my nurse's uniform, but i didn't have time to change before meeting Heather on her birthday.
2. Animal activists, who are as much against keeping pets as they are against hunting, should not be ..... animal lovers, who care for their pets lovingly.
3. Reporting a business's progress should not be a/an ..... but should provide useful information for improving productivity or service quality.
4. Rice and pulses - dried beans, lentils, and chickpeas - cooked with fish, chicken, or pork, are basics in Spanish .....
5. There are plenty of opportunities for ..... in the hotel, such as tennis and golf.